CALSPEC
HOME INSPECTORS, LLC
"Inspected Once, Inspected Right"

January 19, 2011

David Batty
8700 Perkins Drive Unit 2218
Playa Del Rey, California 90293

Re: 1801 Via Estudillo

Dear Mr. Batty,

Thank you so much for the opportunity to serve you and your family by performing a home inspection on the above property. We appreciate the confidence you placed in us by allowing us to serve you in this way.

We realize that purchasing a home can be very stressful. We hope the inspection we performed helped relieve some of that stress. If you have any questions about this inspection please do not hesitate to give us a call.

We would like to take this opportunity to thank you for choosing CalSpec Home Inspectors for your inspection needs.

Receipt of payment:

Payment Received: January 19, 2011
Payment Amount: $395.00 + $199.00 = $574.00
Payment Method:

	CASH	***X***	***CHECK***		***CREDIT CARD***

Sincerely,

Randy Hallford
President & Inspector
CalSpec Home Inspectors, LLC

2470 Stearns Street #314, Simi Valley, California 93063
Phone: (805) 813-3999 Fax: (805) 823-2727
www.californiainspector.com

CALSPEC
HOME INSPECTORS, LLC



14300 Terrabella #100

Report Prepared For:

David Batty

Report Prepared By:

Randy Hallford

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Table of Contents

Table of Contents 3

Summary of Deficiencies 4
Roof 4
Exterior 5
Plumbing 9
Electrical 11
Fireplace 12
Interior 12
Main Sewer Line Inspection 14

General Information 19
Inspection Address 19
Inspection Details 19
Client Information 19
Inspected By 19
Company Information 19

Definitions and Scope 20

Roof 21
Roof Covering 21
Flashing 21
Flashing Condition 21
Gutters Downspouts 21
Chimneys 21

Exterior 22
Building Exterior 22
Foundation 22
Slope and Drainage 22
Drives Walks and Patios 22

HEATING SYSTEM 23
Heating Systems 23
Furnace 23
Exhaust 23
Gas System 23
Ducting Ventilation 23
Air Filter 23

AIR CONDITIONING SYSTEM 24
System Description 24
Thermostat 24
Air Handler Evaporator 24
Coil Condenser 24
Air Ducting 24
Air Filter 24

Plumbing 25
Supply and Piping 25
Water Heater 25
Fuel Tank & Controls 25
Sump Pump 25
Water Controls and Drains 25

Electrical 26
Service Entry 26
Main Disconnect 26
Main Panel 26
Distribution Wiring 26
Smoke Alarm Detectors 26

Fireplace 27
Main Fireplace (living room) 27

Attic, Ventilation & Insulation ... 28
Attic Locations and Access 28
Roof Assembly 28
Attic Floor 28
Attic Insulation 28
Attic Ventilation 28

INTERIOR 29
Room Interior 29
Cabinets and Counters 29
Windows and Doors 29
Garage Door 29

MAIN SEWER LINE INSPECTION 30
Observations 30
Recommendations 30

NACHI Standards of Practice 32
Table of Contents 32
Glossary of Terms 41

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Summary of Deficiencies

Note: This summary is not meant to be technically exhaustive but rather to highlight areas where defects exist. The fact that items are listed here does not necessarily mean that repairs have to be made by the seller. Repair of any of the listed items is subject to negotiation and agreement between the buying and selling parties. Further, the condition of some of the items may already be factored into the selling price asked.

It is entirely the customer's decision whether or not to include additional items from the main report about which they may have concerns.

Further, the Summary is not a substitute for reading and understanding the complete report.

Items marked in **RED** are priority items (either severe safety hazards or extremely costly). If an item is not marked red it may still carry the potential to be a safety concern or costly item. The client should consult with a licensed professional during their inspection period to obtain quotes for any deficiencies listed.

Roof

I recommend a licensed and reputable roofer evaluate, repair and/or replace the following items:

1. Numerous cracked roof tiles were observed on the roof. All cracked and loose tiles may eventually lead to moisture intrusion. These areas of concern were noted in miscellaneous locations all over the roof. I recommend a licensed roofer evaluate and replace all broken tiles.	

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2. I noted one or more concrete exhaust flues on the roof and in the attic. This type of exhaust flue more than likely contains asbestos. These vents can be removed and replaced by a licensed abatement company if required.	

Exterior

1. I noted cracks at the homes stucco siding, driveway, foundation, and interior walls and/or ceilings. Home Inspectors are not qualified to determine the severity of cracks. Only structural engineers are qualified to determine the causes and severity of cracks.	

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2. Portions of the exterior woodwork and painted surfaces are showing deterioration to the paint/stain finish. It is important that these surfaces are kept well protected to ensure a maximum service life. The need for exterior painting is now indicated. Subsequent paint maintenance can be carried out as the usual signs of failure such as cracking, peeling or blistering of the painted surface become evident. Typically this would occur at intervals of five to seven years.	
3. Uneven concrete was noted at the driveway near the garage doors. This uneven concrete may result in water intrusion inside the garage.	

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4. Several sags were noted in the gutter on the front side of the home. I recommend re-sloping to ensure all water is diverted out of the gutter system.	
5. The landscape drain is clogged at the right rear corner of the home. Since the drain is higher than the grade, the drain will not work properly.	
6. Physical damage was noted at the backyard walkway. Repairs are needed to avoid a trip hazard.	

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7. I noted an excessive amount of caulking at the back patio/house intersection. I recommend consulting with the seller to determine the need for this sealant.	
8. Wood destroying insect damage was noted at the wooden columns at the upstairs balcony. I also noted the same type of damage at the balcony deck boards at the north end. I recommend replacing these columns and damaged deck boards for safety purposes.	 

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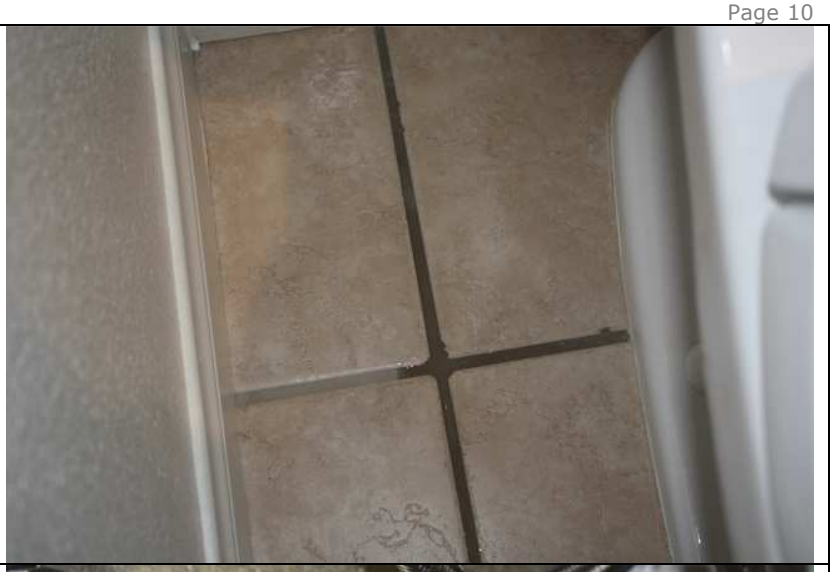
Plumbing

When reference is made to the type of plumbing, the comment relies on a visual observation, seller statements, the presence or absence of a water bond, and what may be present in the way of notification in the electrical service panel. There is no non-invasive way to determine what is behind a closed wall. For example, when copper plumbing is identified, copper piping protrudes from the walls behind plumbing fixtures. If client requires absolute knowledge as to the type of plumbing throughout the home, then a consultation with a licensed plumbing contractor is recommended.

I recommend a licensed and reputable plumber evaluate, repair and/or replace the following items:

1. There is no provision under the water heater for the evacuation of moisture in the event of a catastrophic leak. IRC code 2801.5 and UPC code 510.7 reads in part: "Water heaters in attics or other areas that can be damaged due to leakage shall be installed in a watertight pan." Recommendation: Install a drip pan with a drain line capable of evacuating moisture to the exterior of the home or to an area on the garage or carport floor.	
2. The water heater was missing an extension tube at the pressure relief valve. The TPR extension is meant to reduce the chance of scalding hot water splashing on a person nearby the water heater should the TPR valve activate. Common installation practice is having the tube extend down to floor within 6 to 8 inches (non-threaded end) clearance over a drain or pan to collect hot water. I recommend the installation of a TPR extension tube ASAP per MFG recommendations.	

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3. I noted what appeared to be an active leak next to the master bathroom toilet. I recommend having a licensed plumber evaluate and repair as needed.	
4. The home has galvanized steel waste lines and risers. These lines tend to oxidize, resulting in poor drainage. Evidence of deterioration was noted at the PVC/galvanized steel drain line connection under the master bathroom sink.	
5. The right sink in the master bathroom was broken at the drain line connection. I highly recommend replacing this sink to avoid leaks at this damaged joint.	

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6. There are plumbing components of copper and steel that are in direct contact with each other in the attic. This will sometimes cause a chemical response known as 'galvanic reaction' that accelerates deterioration of the components involved and results in leaks.	

Electrical

I recommend a licensed and reputable electrician evaluate, repair and/or replace the following items:

1. Ground and neutral wires were connected at the same bus bar terminal inside the sub-panel. This is unacceptable and will require repair. All ground and neutral wires should be isolated inside sub-panels.	

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2. Several undersized wires were observed in the garage sub-panel. For example, I noted several 14-guage wires pulling power through a 20-amp breaker. The minimum wire size for a 20-amp breaker is a 12-guage wire. I recommend repair for fire safety purposes.	

Fireplace

I recommend a licensed and reputable chimney professional evaluate, repair and/or replace the following items:

1. The fireplace does not have a rain cap (AKA spark arrestor) installed at the top of the flue. Without a rain cap embers from the fireplace can go up the chimney and land on the roof or nearby vegetation and cause a fire. Also, rain can enter the chimney and rust out the damper or cause other problems. I recommend installing a rain cap to avoid issues in the future.	

Interior

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1. The homes railing have balusters that are spaced more than four inches apart. For the safety of small children, I recommend the railing be replaced or upgraded to ensure there are no openings that exceed four inches. This will decrease the chance of small children falling through the railing and becoming injured or killed.	
2. Some type of bubbling was noted at the wood flooring at the rear living room doors. I recommend consulting with the seller to determine the cause of this unevenness.	
3. Water stains were noted on the ceiling in the upstairs linen closet, and above the 2nd story water heater. These leaks appeared to be inactive, but I was unable to confirm this due to my limited roof inspection (I was unable to walk the second story roof).	

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4. The home contains an acoustic ceiling texture (AKA popcorn texture) that may contain asbestos. Asbestos is a fiber that causes adverse health defects including cancer. I recommend this material be tested for the presence of this harmful material and removed by a licensed abatement company if needed.	
5. I recommend installing mesh at the A/C closet ceiling. Mesh will reduce the chances of rodents entering the interior of the home.	

Main Sewer Line Inspection

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1. Rust stains were noted under several plumbing cleanouts around the home. These stains indicate that sewage/water has backed up and out of the cleanouts. I noted an excessive amount of debris buildup in the cast iron waste/sewer lines. I highly recommend having a licensed plumber snake and/or jet the sewer line to ensure good drainage.

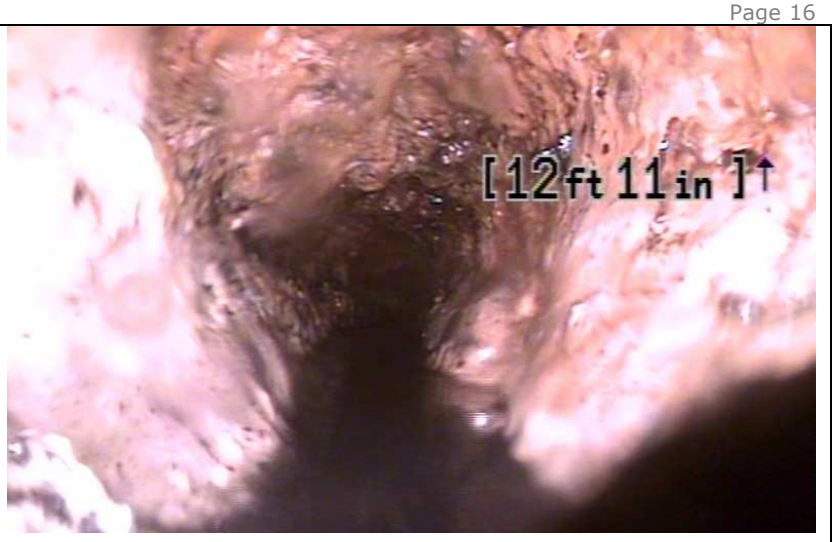
Root intrusion was noted in several sections of the clay pipe. The first area of root intrusion was noted in the middle of the front yard. The root intrusion was located at the top portion of the pipe at this location. Larger roots were evident inside the main sewer line just inches before the city sewer lateral connection. I recommend having a licensed sewer line specialist evaluate and clean/service the line as needed.







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2. The area of root intrusion was noted on the street with a neon dot. Please use the photos in the summary to identify the issue locations. The main root intrusion at the city sewer was approximately 13’ 6” below the street.



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General Information

Inspection Address

Street: 1801 Via Estudillo
City: Palos Verdes Estates
State: California
Zip: 90274

Inspection Details

Inspection Date: January 19, 2011
Report Date: January 19, 2011
Report Delivered: by email
Start Time: 12:00 PM
End Time: 4:00 PM
Weather Conditions: sunny
Temperature: 60 degrees
Present During Inspection: buyer, buyer's agent, and listing agent
Building Occupied: occupied

Client Information

Name: David Batty
Address: 8700 Perkins Drive Unit 2218
City: Playa Del Rey
State: California
Zip: 90293
Cell: 310-990-8349

Inspected By

Name: Randy Hallford

Company Information

Company: CalSpec Home Inspectors
Address: 2470 Stearns Street #314
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State: California
Zip: 93063
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Definitions and Scope

A home inspection is a non-invasive visual examination of a residential dwelling, performed for a fee, which is designed to identify observed material defects within specific components of said dwelling. Components may include any combination of mechanical, structural, electrical, plumbing, or other essential systems or portions of the home, as identified and agreed to by the client and inspector, prior to or during the inspection process.

A home inspection is intended to assist in evaluation of the overall condition of the dwelling. The inspection is based on observation of the visible and apparent condition of the structure and its components on the date of the inspection and not the determination of future conditions.

A home inspection will not reveal every problem that exists or ever could exist, but only those material defects observed on the day of the inspection.

A Material defect is a problem with a residential real property or any portion of it that would have a significant adverse impact on the value of the property or that involves an unreasonable risk to people on the property. The fact that a structural element, system or subsystem is near, at or beyond the end of the normal useful life of such a structural element, system or subsystem is not by itself a material defect.

An Inspection report shall describe and identify in written format the inspected systems, structures, and components of the dwelling and shall identify material defects observed. Inspection reports may contain recommendations regarding conditions reported or recommendations for correction, monitoring or further evaluation by professionals.

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Roof

Inspection of the roof includes the cover, flashing, venting, skylights and chimneys. Ideally, the roof is walked. In cases where walking is not possible, observations are limited to what can be seen by the method employed.

Roof Covering

Roof Inspected: by walking part of the surface
Roof Slope: low pitch
Roof Style: gable
Roofing Materials: synthetic shakes
Material Condition: repairs needed

Flashing

Flashing Type: metal
Flashing Locations: roof/wall intersection

Flashing Condition

Flashing Condition: good condition-no repairs needed

Gutters Downspouts

Gutter Downspout Type: galvanized steel
Gutters Downspouts Drain: onto grade
Disconnected Downspout: at multiple locations around perimeter

Chimneys

Chimneys Type: clay flue
Condition: good condition

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Exterior

Landscaping and lot topography is examined during a residential house inspection as they can have a significant impact on the building structure. It is important that surface runoff water is adequately diverted away from the building, especially in areas that have expansive soil characteristics. Low spots or depressions in the topography can result in ponding water that may exert hydrostatic pressure against the foundation. This pressure can cause a variety of effects on the building. A high water table or excessive ground saturation can also impact septic systems. Even over watering of gardens and shrubbery can have significant effects. A similar impact can result from tree roots growing against the foundation and causing cracking or movement of the structure. It is a standard recommendation that the lot grading slopes away from the building. Grading should fall a minimum of one inch every foot for a distance of six feet around the perimeter of the building. It is also important that tree branches are not permitted to overhang the roof and that all landscaping is kept well pruned and not permitted to grow up against any part of the building. This will help prevent the development of pest and insect problems.

Building Exterior

Wall Surface Material: Portland cement stucco
Condition: good condition
Wall Trim: wood
Condition: repairs needed
Entry Door Types: solid wood
Condition: good condition
Garage Door: wood
Condition: good condition
Eave Type: enclosed and vented wood soffit material
Condition: good condition

Foundation

Foundation Type: slab
Foundation Material: Poured concrete
Inspection Method: walking the perimeter

Slope and Drainage

Direction of Lot Slope: toward the rear and side
Condition: good condition

Drives Walks and Patios

Driveway Types: broomed concrete
Condition: cracks noted
Walkway Type: broomed concrete
Walkway condition: repairs needed

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HEATING SYSTEM

Heating units are tested using normal operating controls. Readily accessible inspection doors are opened for interior viewing unless the doors are taped shut or otherwise sealed. Inspector will not break seals as a new seal is required upon completion of the inspection.

Heating Systems

Type of Heating System: natural gas forced air furnace
Condition: good condition
Heating System Access: in a closet
Location Electric Safety Switch: within sight of the unit
Type of Thermostats: programmable
Location of Thermostats: second floor hall & dining room
Condition: started as expected using normal controls

Furnace

Make: American Standard
Model: AUD100R9V5K4
Serial: 6354P9C1G
Type of Gas: natural gas
Dirt leg present: Yes[1]

Exhaust

Exhaust Vent Type: double-wall metal
Exhausts Through: vents up through the roof
Condition: good condition
Flue Shared with Hot Water: no
Inspection Tag Present: not found

Gas System

Type Gas Line: galvanized steel
Gas Meter Location: south side of the building
Interior Gas Cutoff Location: branch line
Exterior Gas Cutoff Location: at the meter

Ducting Ventilation

Type of Ducting: flexible
Condition: good condition
Type of Return Ducting: flexible
Condition: good condition

Air Filter

Location: return intake
Type: fiberglass cartridge
Condition: good condition

[1] The gas line has a dirt leg installed before the appliance ignition area as appropriate. Dirt legs are designed to keep impurities out of the burn area.

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AIR CONDITIONING SYSTEM

In accordance with the standards of practice of my professional association, I inspect only installed air conditioning units. I am required to operate the system using normal controls and to describe the energy source and distinguishing characteristics in my report. I am not required to determine whether the system is adequately sized for the home, pressure-test the system or inspect for leaking refrigerant, program digital thermostats or controls or operate the setback features of thermostats or controls.

System Description

Type of system: central air conditioner
Energy source: electricity
Exchange Method: air source[1]

Thermostat

Type: programmable
Locations: second floor hall & dining room
Thermostat Condition: good condition
Location of Cutoff: within sight of the unit

Air Handler Evaporator

Inside Unit Location: closet
Condition: good condition
Make: Benchmark
Model: NMC160266
Serial: 2XUC1360/100

Coil Condenser

Outside Unit Location: right side of the home
Condition: good condition
Make: Bryant
Model: 538ANR060000BAA
Serial: 1007X91407

Air Ducting

Type of Ducting: flexible
Condition: Good condition
Type of Return Ducting: flexible
Condition: Good condition

Air Filter

Location: Same as heating system
Type: Fiberglass cartridge
Condition: good condition

[1] The heat pump is an air source type that gathers latent heat from the exterior air and transfers it to the interior coil in order to heat the home in winter. When used to cool a home the latent heat from the interior is gathered through the interior coil and transferred to the outside air.

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Plumbing

The inspection of the plumbing system includes checking all faucets and fixtures for cross-connection and leaks. Cross-contamination issues are also included as well as pressure, functional flow and functional drainage.

Supply and Piping

Supply and Waste System: municipal supply and waste system
Service Piping Size: 1-inch
Service Piping Type: copper
Branch Piping Size: 1/2-inch
Branch Piping Type: copper
Condition: good condition
Fixtures/Faucets Condition: good condition
Supports/Insulation Condition: no access - not inspected
Functional Flow: good condition
Function Drainage: repairs needed
Waste Piping: ABS plastic, galvanized steel, and cast iron
Condition: repairs needed
Vent Piping: galvanized steel
Condition: good condition

Water Heater

Water Heater Type: one conventional storage tank
Water Heater Energy Source: natural gas
Capacity: 38 & 50 Gallons
Date of Manufacture: not listed & 2008
Make: State Industries
Model: GSX40XBRT & GS650UBRT
Serial No.: C04103559 & 0823T001534
Water Heater Location: garage & upstairs closet
Condition: good condition
Water Heater Vented: through the roof via a B-vent

Fuel Tank & Controls

Fuel Shut Off Location: at water heater
Automatic Safety Controls (TPR) Condition: good condition

Sump Pump

Tested: none

Water Controls and Drains

Main Water Shut Off Location: south exterior of building
Main Water Regulator Location: south entry hose bib
Waste Clean Out Locations: west exterior of building

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Electrical

Service Entry

Service Drop Type: underground service lateral
Condition: good condition
Service Entry Conductor: aluminum
Condition: good condition
Service Ground Conductor: single-conductor copper
Service Ground Location: plumbing system
Condition: good condition-for what could be seen
Meter Location: west side of the residence

Main Disconnect

Main Disconnect Type: breaker
Main Disconnect Rating: 200 amps
Main Disconnect Location: inside the service entrance panel

Main Panel

Service Entrance Panel Location: back side of the home
Panel Type: Murray
Panel Style: breaker system
Amperage Rating: 200/60 amps
Voltage Rating: 120/240 volts
Condition: good condition
Final Service Rating: 200 amps

Distribution Wiring

Wiring Type: non-metallic sheathed cable (Romex), and flex
Wiring Conductors: copper
Condition: good condition
GFCI Locations: found in some areas
Outlets & Switches Tested: all accessible
Polarity & Ground Tested: all accessible

Smoke Alarm Detectors

Smoke Alarms: Alarms Found

Carbon monoxide detectors should be installed inside every home that contains any form of gas appliance.

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Fireplace

Main Fireplace (living room)

Fireplace Type: natural gas & masonry
Fireplace Location: living room
Supply Air: by scavenging room air
Fireplace Liner: clay
Hearth Style: floor level

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Attic, Ventilation & Insulation

The inspection of the insulation, vapor retarders and ventilation systems of this home was limited to only unfinished, accessible areas that are exposed to view. No invasive inspection methods were used, therefore the presence of required vapor retarders or the type and density of insulation installed behind finished surfaces could not be verified. Even if the type of materials used could be determined, no declarations have been made here as to the installed density or adequacy of concealed materials.

Should the client(s) wish detailed information concerning the existence/condition of any vapor retarders and insulation concealed in the walls, ceiling cavities or other inaccessible and/or unviewable areas, I suggest consulting an insulation contractor or certified energy auditor. Many have thermal imaging equipment that can aid in determining the overall effectiveness of installed insulation systems and identify areas needing improvement.

Attic Locations and Access

Attic Spaces: one
Attic Access Locations: main hallway
Inspection Method: flashlight

Roof Assembly

Roof Assembly Type: wood frame assembly
Rafter: 4 by 6
Rafter On-Center: 24-inch
Roof Sheathing: plywood / one by's
Ceiling Joist: 2 by 6
Ceiling Joist On-Center: 24-inch
Condition: good condition

Attic Floor

Attic Flooring: none
Attic Storage: cannot be used

Attic Insulation

Insulated at: ceiling
Certificate Posted: no certificate
Floor Insulation Type: fiberglass
Floor Measure: 8-10 inches
Floor Vapor Retarder: none found
Condition: good condition

Attic Ventilation

Attic Ventilation Type: passive ventilation
Intake Location: continuous soffit vents
Exhaust Location: eave vents

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INTERIOR

Room Interior

Heat Source: ceiling registers
Wall Surface Type: drywall
Condition: good condition
Ceiling Surface Type: drywall
Condition: repairs needed
Flooring Type: carpet, hardwood, and ceramic tile
Condition: good condition
Kitchen Flooring Material: ceramic tile
Condition: good condition
Kitchen Counter Top Type: granite
Condition: good condition

Cabinets and Counters

Kitchen Cabinet Type: plywood
Condition: good condition
Bathroom Flooring Material: ceramic tile
Condition: good condition
Bathroom Counter Top Type: granite
Condition: good condition
Bathroom Cabinet Type: plywood
Condition: good condition
Inside Door Type: hollow core wood panel
Condition: good condition

Windows and Doors

Window Frame Type: wood
Window Pane Type: dual glazed
Condition: good condition
Safety Glazing: at doors
Security Bar Locations: none

Garage Door

Garage Door Type: wood
Condition: good condition
Garage Walk Through Door: solid wood
Garage Walk Through Door Condition: good condition
Fire Separation Walls and Ceilings Condition: good condition

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MAIN SEWER LINE INSPECTION

This is a specialty inspection of the main sewer line only. The main sewer line is that portion of the waste drainage piping system that is exterior to the structure and carries the building waste from the building drain (that portion of the waste drainage piping system that is under/interior to the structure) to the city sewer connection under the street.

The findings of this inspection are based on the opinions and education of the inspector and reflect the conditions discovered at the time of inspection only.

The following is based on a video line inspection of the sewer line only. This inspection is exclusive to the main sewer line and does not include any part of the water supply system or above around waste line pipes (unless otherwise stated in this report).

This report is not intended as a code inspection nor is it intended to itemize every "flaw". It is intended to give an overall condition of the main sewer line.

The findings of this inspection are based on the opinions and education of the inspector and reflect the condition discovered at the time of inspection only.

Observations

Access Location

The main sewer line was accessed through a plumbing cleanout at the back of the home.

Plumbing Cleanouts

Multiple cleanouts were noted around the home. Only one main cleanout was noted, and it was on the backside of the home.

Condition of Main Sewer Line

Serviceable condition

Rust stains were noted under several plumbing cleanouts around the home. These stains indicate that sewage/water has backed up and out of the cleanouts. I noted an excessive amount of debris buildup in the cast iron waste/sewer lines. I highly recommend having a licensed plumber snake and/or jet the sewer line to ensure good drainage.

Root intrusion was noted in several sections of the clay pipe. The first area of root intrusion was noted in the middle of the front yard. The root intrusion was located at the top portion of the pipe at this location. Larger roots were evident inside the main sewer line just inches before the city sewer lateral connection. I recommend having a licensed sewer line specialist evaluate and clean/service the line as needed.

The area of root intrusion was noted on the street with a neon dot. Please use the photos in the summary to identify the issue locations. The main root intrusion at the city sewer was approximately 13’ 6” below the street.

Recommendations

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The following recommendations are based on the inspectors experience, education and opinions. This is not a guarantee of costs for any work to be performed and is not a warranty for any work to be performed.

Only qualified licensed contractors should be used to perform any repairs or reconstruction. It is recommended, for health and safety reasons, that a high level of integrity be maintained for the sewer line system. This includes yearly servicing and regular inspections.

Maintenance

All sewer lines should have cleanings performed to them on an annual schedule. This service is provided by a sewer-cleaning agency and is performed to help minimize potential future blockages and/or damage within the main sewer line.

All sewer lines should be examined for damage after any significant seismic activity and every few years to monitor the overall condition of the line.

Yours truly,

Randy Hallford
CalSpec Home Inspectors
805-813-3999

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NACHI Standards of Practice

Table of Contents

1. Definitions and Scope
2. Standards of Practice
2.1. Roof
2.2. Exterior
2.3. Basement, Foundation, Crawlspace & Structure
2.4. Heating
2.5. Cooling
2.6. Plumbing
2.7. Electrical
2.8. Fireplace
2.9. Attic & Insulation
2.10. Doors, Windows & Interior
3. Limitations, Exceptions & Exclusions
4. Glossary of Terms

1. Definitions and Scope

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II. A home inspection will not reveal every problem that exists or ever could exist, but only those material defects observed on the day of the inspection.

1.2. A Material defect is a problem with a residential real property or any portion of it that would have a significant adverse impact on the value of the property or that involves an unreasonable risk to people on the property. The fact that a structural element, system or subsystem is near, at or beyond the end of the normal useful life of such a structural element, system or subsystem is not by itself a material defect.

1.3. An Inspection report shall describe and identify in written format the inspected systems, structures, and components of the dwelling and shall identify material defects observed. Inspection reports may contain recommendations regarding conditions reported or recommendations for correction, monitoring or further evaluation by professionals.

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2. Standards of Practice

2.1. Roof

I. The inspector shall inspect from ground level or eaves:

A. The roof covering.
B. The gutters.
C. The downspouts.
D. The vents, flashings, skylights, chimney and other roof penetrations.
E. The general structure of the roof from the readily accessible panels, doors or stairs.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Walk on any roof surface.
B. Predict the service life expectancy.
C. Inspect underground downspout diverter drainage pipes.
D. Remove snow, ice, debris or other conditions that prohibit the observation of the roof surfaces.
E. Inspect antennae, lightning arresters, or similar attachments.

2.2. Exterior

I. The inspector shall inspect:

A. The flashing and trim.
B. All exterior doors, decks, stoops, steps, stairs, porches, railings, eaves, soffits, fascias, grading, and walkways.
C. And report as in need of repair any spacings between intermediate balusters, spindles, or rails for steps, stairways, balconies, and railings that permit the passage of an object greater than four inches in diameter.
D. The vegetation, surface drainage and retaining walls when these are likely to adversely affect the building.
E. And describe the exterior wall covering.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Inspect or operate screens, storm windows, shutters, awnings, fences, outbuildings, or exterior accent lighting.
B. Inspect items, including window and door flashings, which are not visible or readily accessible from the ground.
C. Inspect geological, geotechnical, or hydrological conditions.
D. Inspect recreational facilities.
E. Inspect seawalls, break-walls and docks.
F. Inspect erosion control and earth stabilization measures.
G. Inspect for safety type glass.
H. Inspect underground utilities.
I. Inspect underground items.
J. Inspect wells or springs.
K. Inspect solar systems.
L. Inspect swimming pools or spas.
M. Inspect septic systems or cesspools.
N. Inspect playground equipment.

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O. Inspect sprinkler systems.
P. Inspect drain fields or drywells.
Q. Determine the integrity of the thermal window seals or damaged glass.

2.3. Basement, Foundation & Crawlspace

I. The inspector shall inspect:

A. The basement.
B. The foundation
C. The crawlspace.
D. The visible structural components.
E. Any present conditions or indications of active water penetration by probing a representative sampling of structural components where deterioration is believed to be present or where clear indications of deterioration are present.
F. And report any general indications of foundation movement that are observed, such as but not limited to sheetrock cracks, brick cracks, out-of-square door frames or floor slopes.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Enter any crawlspaces that are not readily accessible or where entry could cause damage or pose a hazard to the inspector in his or her opinion.
B. Move stored items or debris.
C. Operate sump pumps with inaccessible floats.
D. Identify size, spacing, span, location or adequacy of foundation bolting, bracing, joists or support systems.
E. Provide any engineering or architectural service.
F. Report on the adequacy of any structural system or component.

2.4. Heating

I. The inspector shall inspect:

A. The heating system and describe the energy source and heating method using normal operating controls.
B. And report as in need of repair electric furnaces which do not operate.
C. And report if inspector deemed the furnace inaccessible.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Inspect or evaluate interiors of flues or chimneys, fire chambers, the heat exchanger, the humidifier or dehumidifier, the electronic air filter, solar heating systems or fuel tanks.
B. Inspect underground fuel tanks.
C. Determine the uniformity, temperature, flow, balance, distribution, size, capacity, BTU, or supply adequacy of the heating system.
D. Light pilot flames.
E. Activate heating, heat pump systems, or other heating systems when ambient temperatures or other circumstances are not conducive to safe operation or may damage the equipment.
F. Operate electronic thermostats.
G. Evaluate fuel quality.

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2.5. Cooling

I. The inspector shall inspect:

A. The central cooling equipment using normal operating controls.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Determine the uniformity, temperature, flow, balance, distribution, size, capacity, BTU, or supply adequacy of the cooling system.
B. Inspect window units, through-wall units, or electronic air filters.
C. Operate equipment or systems if exterior temperature is below 60 degrees Fahrenheit or when other circumstances are not conducive to safe operation or may damage the equipment.
D. Inspect or determine thermostat calibration, heat anticipation or automatic setbacks or clocks.
E. Examine electrical current, coolant fluids or gasses, or coolant leakage.

2.6. Plumbing

I. The inspector shall:

A. Inspect the main water shut off valve.
B. Inspect the water heating system.
C. Flush toilets.
D. Run water in sinks, tubs, and showers.
E. Inspect the interior water supply including all fixtures and faucets.
F. Inspect the drain, waste and vent systems, including all fixtures.
G. Describe any visible fuel storage systems.
H. Inspect the drainage sump pumps testing sumps with accessible floats.
I. Inspect and describe the water supply, drain, waste and main fuel shut-off valves, as well as the location of the water main and main fuel shut-off valves.
J. Inspect and determine if the water supply is public or private.
K. Inspect and report as in need of repair deficiencies in the water supply by viewing the functional flow in two fixtures operated simultaneously.
L. Inspect and report as in need of repair deficiencies in installation and identification of hot and cold faucets.
M. Inspect and report as in need of repair mechanical drain-stops that are missing or do not operate if installed in sinks, lavatories and tubs.
N. Inspect and report as in need of repair commodes that have cracks in the ceramic material, are improperly mounted on the floor, leak, or have tank components which do not operate.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Light pilot flames.
B. Determine the size, temperature, age, life expectancy or adequacy of the water heater.
C. Inspect interiors of flues or chimneys, water softening or filtering systems, well pumps or tanks, safety or shut-of valves, floor drains or sprinkler systems.
D. Determine the exact flow rate, volume, pressure, temperature, or adequacy of the water supply.
E. Determine the water quality or potability or the reliability of the water supply or source.
F. Open closed plumbing access panels.
G. Inspect clothes washing machine connections.
H. Operate any main, branch or fixture valve except fixture faucets and hose faucets attached to the building.

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I. Test shower pans, tub and shower surrounds or enclosures for leakage.
J. Evaluate the compliance with local or state conservation or energy standards, or the proper design or sizing of any water, waste or venting components, fixtures or piping.
K. Determine the effectiveness of anti-siphon, back-flow prevention or drain-stop devices.
L. Determine whether there are sufficient clean-outs for effective cleaning of drains.
M. Evaluate gas, liquid propane or oil storage tanks.
N. Excavate or otherwise uncover the private sewage system or its components to determine size, adequacy or efficiency.
O. Inspect water treatment systems or water filters.
P. Inspect pressure pumps or bladder tanks.

2.7. Electrical

I. The inspector shall inspect:

A. The service line.
B. The meter box.
C. The main disconnect.
D. And determine the service amperage.
E. Panels, breakers and fuses.
F. The grounding.
G. The bonding.
H. A representative sampling of switches, receptacles, light fixtures, and ground circuit interrupters.
I. And report the presence of solid conductor aluminum branch circuit wiring if readily visible.
J. And report on any GFCI-tested receptacles in which power is not present, polarity is incorrect, the receptacle is not grounded, is not secured to the wall, the cover is not in place, the ground fault circuit interrupter devices are not properly installed or do not operate properly, or evidence of arcing or excessive heat is present.
K. The service entrance conductors and the condition of their sheathing.
L. The ground fault circuit interrupters with a GFCI tester.
M. And describe the amperage rating of the service.
N. And report the absence of smoke detectors.
O. Service entrance cables and report as in need of repair deficiencies in the integrity of the insulation, drip loop, or separation of conductors at weatherheads and clearances.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Insert any tool, probe or device into the main or sub-panels.
B. Operate electrical systems that are shut down.
C. Remove panel covers or dead front covers if not readily accessible.
D. Operate over current protection devices.
E. Operate non-accessible smoke detectors.
F. Measure or determine the amperage or voltage of the main service if not visibly labeled.
G. Inspect the alarm system and components.
H. Inspect the ancillary wiring.
I. Activate any electrical systems or branch circuits which are not energized.
J. Operate overload devices.
K. Inspect low voltage systems, electrical de-icing tapes, swimming pool wiring or any time-controlled devices.
L. Verify the continuity of the connected service ground.
M. Inspect private or emergency electrical supply sources, including but not limited to generators, windmills, photovoltaic solar collectors, or battery or electrical storage facility.

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N. Inspect spark or lightning arrestors.
O. Conduct drop voltage calculations.
P. Determine the accuracy of breaker labeling.

2.8. Fireplace

I. The inspector shall inspect:

A. The fireplace, and open and close the damper door if readily accessible and operable.
B. Hearth extensions and other permanently installed components.
C. And report as in need of repair deficiencies in the lintel, hearth and material surrounding the fireplace, including clearance from combustible materials

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Inspect the vent system.
B. Inspect the interior of the chimney or flue, fire doors or screens, seals or mantels.
C. Determine the need for a chimney sweep.
D. Operate gas fireplace inserts.
E. Light pilot flames.
F. Determine the appropriateness of such installation.
G. Inspect automatic fuel feed devices.
H. Inspect combustion make up devices.
I. Inspect heat distribution assists whether gravity controlled or fan assisted.
J. Ignite or extinguish fires.
K. Determine draft characteristics.
L. Move fireplace inserts, stoves, or firebox contents.
M. Determine adequacy of draft, perform a smoke test or dismantle or remove any component.

2.9. Attic, Ventilation & Insulation

I. The inspector shall inspect:

A. The insulation in unfinished spaces.
B. The ventilation of attic spaces.
C. Mechanical ventilation systems.
D. And report on the general absence or lack of insulation.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Enter the attic or unfinished spaces that are not readily accessible or where entry could cause damage or pose a safety hazard to the inspector in his or her opinion.
B. To move or touch insulation.
C. To move or touch vapor retarders.
D. Break or otherwise damage the surface finish or weather seal on or around access panels and covers.
E. Identify the composition or the exact R-value of insulation material.
F. Activate thermostatically operated fans.
G. Determine the types of materials used in insulation/wrapping of pipes, ducts, jackets, boilers, and wiring.

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2.10. Doors, Windows & Interior

I. The inspector shall:

A. Open and close a representative number of doors and windows.
B. Inspect the walls, ceilings, steps, stairways, and railings.
C. Inspect garage doors and garage door openers by operating first by remote (if available) and then by the installed automatic door control.
D. And report as in need of repair any installed electronic sensors that are not operable or not installed at proper heights above the garage door.
E. And report as in need of repair any door locks or side ropes that have not been removed or disabled when garage door opener is in use.
F. And report as in need of repair any windows that are obviously fogged or display other evidence of broken seals.

II. The inspector is not required to:

A. Inspect paint, wallpaper, window treatments or finish treatments.
B. Inspect central vacuum systems.
C. Inspect safety glazing in locations subject to human impact.
D. Inspect security components.
E. Evaluate the fastening of countertops, cabinets, sink tops and fixtures, or firewall compromises.
F. Move furniture, stored items, or any coverings like carpets or rugs in order to inspect the concealed floor structure.
G. Move drop ceiling tiles.
H. Inspect or move any household appliances.
I. Inspect or operate equipment housed in the garage except as otherwise noted.
J. Verify or certify safe operation of any auto reverse or related safety function of a garage door.
K. Operate or evaluate security bar release and opening mechanisms, whether interior or exterior, including compliance with local, state, or federal standards.
L. Operate any system, appliance or component that requires the use of special keys, codes, combinations, or devices.
M. Operate or evaluate self-cleaning oven cycles or signal lights.
N. Determine leakage from microwave ovens.
O. Operate or examine any sauna, steam-jenny, kiln, toaster, ice-maker, coffee-maker, can-opener, bread-warmer, blender, instant hot water dispenser, or other small, ancillary devices.
P. Inspect elevators.
Q. Inspect central vacuums.
R. Inspect appliances.
S. Inspect items not permanently installed.
T. Examine or operate any above-ground, movable, freestanding, or otherwise non-permanently installed pool/spa or self-contained equipment.
U. Come into contact with any pool or spa water in order to determine the system structure or components.
V. Determine the adequacy of spa jet water force or bubble effect.
W. Determine the structural integrity or leakage of a pool or spa.

3. Limitations, Exceptions & Exclusions

3.1. Limitations:

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I. An inspection is not technically exhaustive.
II. An inspection will not identify concealed or latent defects.
III. An inspection will not deal with aesthetic concerns or what could be deemed matters of taste, cosmetic, etc.
IV. An inspection will not determine the suitability of the property for any use.
V. An inspection does not determine the market value of the property or its marketability.
VI. An inspection does not determine the advisability or inadvisability of the purchase of the inspected property.
VII. An inspection does not determine the life expectancy of the property or any components or systems therein.
VIII. An inspection does not include items not permanently installed.
IX. These Standards of Practice apply only to homes with four or fewer dwelling units.

3.2. Exclusions:

I. The inspectors are not required to determine:

A. Property boundary lines or encroachments.
B. The condition of any component or system that is not readily accessible.
C. The service life expectancy of any component or system.
D. The size, capacity, BTU, performance, or efficiency of any component or system.
E. The cause or reason of any condition.
F. The cause for the need of repair or replacement of any system or component.
G. Future conditions.
H. The compliance with codes or regulations.
I. The presence of evidence of rodents, animals or insects.
J. The presence of mold, mildew or fungus.
K. The presence of air-borne hazards.
L. The presence of birds.
M. The presence of other flora or fauna.
N. The air quality.
O. The existence of asbestos.
P. The existence of environmental hazards.
Q. The existence of electro-magnetic fields.
R. The presence of hazardous materials including, but not limited to, the presence of lead in paint.
S. Any hazardous waste conditions.
T. Any manufacturer recalls or conformance with manufacturer installation or any information included in the consumer protection bulletin.
U. Operating costs of systems.
V. Replacement or repair cost estimates.
W. The acoustical properties of any systems.
X. Estimates of how much it will cost to run any given system.

II. The inspectors are not required to operate:

A. Any system that is shut down.
B. Any system that does not function properly.
C. Or evaluate low voltage electrical systems such as, but not limited to:
1. Phone lines.
2. Cable lines.
3. Antennae.

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4. Lights.
5. Remote controls.
D. Any system that does not turn on with the use of normal operating controls.
E. Any shut off valve.
F. Any electrical disconnect or over current protection devices.
G. Any alarm systems.
H. Moisture meters, gas detectors or similar equipment.

III. The inspectors are not required to:

A. Move any personal items or other obstructions, such as, but not limited to:

1. Throw rugs.
2. Furniture.
3. Floor or wall coverings.
4. Ceiling tiles
5. Window coverings.
6. Equipment.
7. Plants.
8. Ice.
9. Debris.
10. Snow.
11. Water.
12. Dirt.
13. Foliage.
14. Pets

B. Dismantle, open, or uncover any system or component.
C. Enter or access any area which may, in the opinion of the inspector, to be unsafe or risk personal safety.
D. Enter crawlspaces or other areas that are unsafe or not readily accessible.
E. Inspect underground items such as, but not limited to, underground storage tanks or other indications of their presence, whether abandoned or actively used.
F. Do anything which, in the inspector's opinion, is likely to be unsafe or dangerous to the inspector or others or damage property, such as, but not limited to, walking on roof surfaces, climbing ladders, entering attic spaces or negotiating with dogs.
G. Inspect decorative items.
H. Inspect common elements or areas in multi-unit housing.
I. Inspect intercoms, speaker systems, radio-controlled, security devices or lawn irrigation systems.
J. Offer guarantees or warranties.
K. Offer or perform any engineering services.
L. Offer or perform any trade or professional service other than home inspection.
M. Research the history of the property, report on its potential for alteration, modification, extendibility, or its suitability for a specific or proposed use for occupancy.
N. Determine the age of construction or installation of any system structure, or component of a building, or differentiate between original construction or subsequent additions, improvements, renovations or replacements thereto.
O. Determine the insurability of a property.

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Glossary of Terms

4.1. Accessible: Can be approached or entered by the inspector safely, without difficulty, fear or danger.

4.2. Activate: To turn on, supply power, or enable systems, equipment, or devices to become active by normal operating controls. Examples include turning on the gas or water supply valves to the fixtures and appliances and activating electrical breakers or fuses.

4.3. Adversely Affect: Constitute, or potentially constitute, a negative or destructive impact.

4.4. Alarm System: Warning devices, installed or free-standing, including but not limited to: Carbon monoxide detectors, flue gas and other spillage detectors, security equipment, ejector pumps and smoke alarms.

4.5. Appliance: A household device operated by use of electricity or gas. Not included in this definition are components covered under central heating, central cooling or plumbing.

4.6. Architectural Service: Any practice involving the art and science of building design for construction of any structure or grouping of structures and the use of space within and surrounding the structures or the design, design development, preparation of construction contract documents, and administration of the construction contract.

4.7. Component: A permanently installed or attached fixture, element or part of a system.

4.8. Condition: The visible and conspicuous state of being of an object.

4.9. Crawlspace: The area within the confines of the foundation and between the ground and the underside of the lowest floor structural component.

4.10. Decorative: Ornamental; not required for the operation of essential systems and components of a home.

4.11. Describe: Report in writing a system or component by its type, or other observed characteristics, to distinguish it from other components used for the same purpose.

4.12. Determine: To arrive at an opinion or conclusion pursuant to examination.

4.13. Dismantle: To open, take apart or remove any component, device or piece that would not typically be opened, taken apart or removed by an ordinary occupant.

4.14. Engineering Service: Any professional service or creative work requiring engineering education, training, and experience and the application of special knowledge of the mathematical, physical and engineering sciences to such professional service or creative work as consultation, investigation, evaluation, planning, design and supervision of construction for the purpose of assuring compliance with the specifications and design, in conjunction with structures, buildings, machines, equipment, works or processes.

4.15. Enter: To go into an area to observe all visible components.

4.16. Evaluate: To assess the systems, structures or components of a dwelling.

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4.17. Examine: To visually look. See Inspect.

4.18. Foundation: The base upon which the structure or wall rests; usually masonry, concrete, or stone, and generally partially underground.

4.19. Function: The action for which an item, component, or system is specially fitted or used or for which an item, component or system exists; to be in action or perform a task.

4.20. Functional: Performing, or able to perform, a function.

4.21. Home Inspection: The process by which an inspector visually examines the readily accessible systems and components of a home and operates those systems and components utilizing these Standards of Practice as a guideline.

4.22. Household Appliances: Kitchen and laundry appliances, room air conditioners, and similar appliances.

4.23. Inspect: To visually look at readily accessible systems and components safely, using normal operating controls and accessing readily accessible panels and areas.
4.24. Inspected Property: The readily accessible areas of the buildings, site, items, components, and systems included in the inspection.

4.25. Inspector: One who performs a real estate inspection.

4.26. Installed: Attached or connected such that the installed item requires tool for removal.

4.27. Material Defect: Refer to section 1.2.

4.28. Normal Operating Controls: Devices such as thermostats that would be operated by ordinary occupants which require no specialized skill or knowledge.

4.29. Observe: To see through visually directed attention.

4.30. Operate: To cause systems to function or turn on with normal operating controls.

4.31. Readily Accessible: An item or component is readily accessible if, in the judgment of the inspector, it is capable of being safely observed without movement of obstacles, detachment or disengagement of connecting or securing devices, or other unsafe or difficult procedures to gain access.

4.32. Recreational Facilities: Spas, saunas, steam baths, swimming pools, tennis courts, playground equipment, and other exercise, entertainment or athletic facilities.

4.33. Report: A written communication (possibly including digital images) of any material defects seen during the inspection.

4.34. Representative Number: A sufficient number to serve as a typical or characteristic example of the item(s) inspected.

4.35. Safety Glazing: Tempered glass, laminated glass, or rigid plastic.

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4.36. Shut Down: Turned off, unplugged, inactive, not in service, not operational, etc.

4.37. Structural Component: A component which supports non-variable forces or weights (dead loads) and variable forces or weights (live loads).

4.38. System: An assembly of various components to function as a whole.

4.39. Technically Exhaustive: A comprehensive and detailed examination beyond the scope of a real estate home inspection which would involve or include, but would not be limited to: dismantling, specialized knowledge or training, special equipment, measurements, calculations, testing, research, analysis or other means.

4.40. Unsafe: A condition in a readily accessible, installed system or component which is judged to be a significant risk of personal injury during normal, day-to-day use. The risk may be due to damage, deterioration, improper installation or a change in accepted residential construction standards.

4.41. Verify: To confirm or substantiate.

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